138 **‘He was quite taken with cheetah hunting’:** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 4, p. 511

138 **Samand Malik, was carried in a litter:** Enayatullah Khan, ‘Akbar and His Cheetahs’, *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Vol. 73, 2012, p. 463.

140 **‘set alight, and watched burn, a crowded pilgrim ship’:** M. N. Pearson, *The Cambridge History of India: The Portuguese in India*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2006, p. 71.

140 **‘during the government of the Malik, the Firangi was unable to enter the Gujarat ports’:** Habib (ed.), *Akbar and His India*, p. 258.

140 **‘the merchants of Rum, Syria, Persia and Turan’:** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 3, p. 13.

140 **fifteenth-century text of the region called the *Varnak Samucay*:** Aparna Kapadia, ‘Why a 15th-century manuscript of Indian recipes lists eight kinds of samosas—none with potatoes’, *Scroll.in*, 9 September 2019.

141 **‘neither eat nor kill any living thing’:** Guiseppe De Lorenzo, ‘India in the Letters of Pietro della Valle’, *East and West*, Vol. 7, No. 3, October 1956, pp. 212–13.

141 **‘very beautiful with their horns decorated with gold and jewels…’:** Ibid., p. 212.

141 **engaged in buying Gujarati goods to send to Goa:** Pearson, *The Portuguese in India*, p. 83.

142 **Akbar would cut taxes on the export and import of goods:** *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Part 1, 2007, p. 244.

142 **‘evil-conditioned men’:** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 3, p. 9.

142 **‘roared loudly like a lion and called his men’:** Qandahari, *Tarikh-i-Akbari*, p. 194.

143 **‘We have ordered that Rumi Khan should make ready 500 pieces of Daudi’:** Iqtidar Alam Khan, ‘Fath-Nama-I Gujarat (Akbar’s letter to Munim Khan)’, *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Vol. 29, Part 1, 1967, p. 147.

143 **He [Akbar] is such an expert in espionage that he keeps four thousand:** Qandahari, *Tarikh-i-Akbari*, p. 62.

144 **‘about the wonders of Portugal and the manners and customs of Europe’:** Beveridge (trans.), Akbarnama, Vol. 3, p. 27.

144 **‘scent turned the lions of skies dead-drunk’:** Ibid., p. 199.

144 **issued passes to members of Akbar’s family to go on pilgrimage:** Habib (ed.), *Akbar and His India*, p. 260.

145 **‘so that the latter would transfix them and come out at their backs’:** Moosvi, *Episodes in the Life of Akbar*, p. 40.

145 **‘declared that if Rajputs were wont to sell their valour’:** Ibid., p. 41.

145 **‘the best of these houses from the roadside look like hell’:** Quoted in Shireen Moosvi, ‘Urban Houses and Building: Use in Mughal India’, *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Vol. 72, Part 1, 2011, p. 424.

145 **‘build their houses more for the benefit of the onlookers’:** Ibid.

146 **‘Proclaim the manifestation of your Mahdiship’:** Stephen P. Blake, ‘Chronology: Millenarian’, *Time in Early Modern Islam: Calendar, Ceremony, and Chronology in the Safavid, Mughal and Ottoman Empires*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, pp. 141–73.

147 **‘His majesty’, wrote Jahangir:** Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*, Vol. 2, p. 40.

147–48 **‘had favoured him from his very infancy’:** Thackston (trans.), *Jahangirnama*, p. 63.

148 **‘It gets up in great strength every year in the heats’:** Eraly, *The Last Spring*, Part 2, p. 3.

149 **‘like the full moon, traversed an immense distance in the night’:** Moosvi, *Episodes in the Life of Akbar*, p. 44.